

BEFORE THE IOWA BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL SCIENCE

RE: Mental Health Counselor License of HEATHER SAYER License No. 001736 Respondent	CASE NO. 21-0097 COMBINED STATEMENT OF CHARGES, SETTLEMENT AGREEMENT, AND FINAL ORDER
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COME NOW the Iowa Board of Behavioral Science (“Board”) and Heather Sayer (“Respondent”), 5360 Sevenoaks Dr, Colorado Springs CO 80919, and enter into this Combined Statement of Charges, Settlement Agreement, and Final Order (“Order”) pursuant to Iowa Code sections 17A.10 and 272C.3(4), and 645 Iowa Administrative Code (IAC) 12.1. The Board has the authority to take disciplinary action pursuant to Iowa Code sections 147.55 and 272C.3, and 645 IAC chapter 33.

A. STATEMENT OF CHARGES

COUNT I

1. Respondent is charged under 645 IAC 33.2(1)“b” with failure to comply with the Code of Ethics of the American Counseling Association (2014), specifically A.5.e. (Personal Virtual Relationships with Current Clients), A.6.b. (Extending Counseling Boundaries, and A.6.e. (Nonprofessional Interactions or Relationships).

B. FACTUAL CIRCUMSTANCES

2. Respondent holds mental health counselor license number 001736, which is currently active through September 30, 2022.

3. Respondent failed to establish and maintain boundaries with a client during the therapeutic relationship and after the therapeutic relationship ended.

C. SETTLEMENT AGREEMENT AND FINAL ORDER

4. The Board has jurisdiction over Respondent and the subject matter of this proceeding.

5. Respondent acknowledges that the allegations in the Statement of Charges, if proven in a contested case hearing, would constitute grounds for the discipline agreed to in this Order.

6. Execution of this Order constitutes the resolution of a contested case. Respondent has a right to a hearing before the Board on the charges, but Respondent waives the right to a hearing and all attendant rights, including the right to appeal or seek judicial review of the Board’s action, by freely and voluntarily entering into this Order. Once entered, this Order shall have the force and effect of a disciplinary order entered following a contested case hearing.

7. Respondent acknowledges that they have the right to be represented by counsel on this

matter.

8. This Order is subject to approval by a majority of the full Board. If the Board does not approve this Order, it shall be of no force or effect to either party, and shall not be admissible for any purpose in further proceedings in this matter. If the Board approves this Order, it shall be the full and final resolution of this matter.

9. This Order shall be part of Respondent's permanent record and shall be considered by the Board in determining the nature and severity of any disciplinary action to be imposed in the event of any future violations.

10. Respondent understands the Board is required by federal law to report any adverse action to the National Practitioner Data Bank.

11. This Order, when fully executed, is a public record and is available for inspection and copying in accordance with the requirements of Iowa Code chapters 22 and 272C.

12. The Board's approval of this Order shall constitute a **FINAL ORDER** of the Board.

IT IS THEREFORE ORDERED:

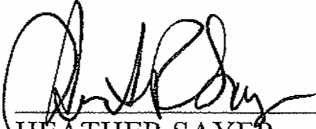
13. Respondent ceased practice in Iowa effective May 1, 2022. Respondent agrees to an **INDEFINITE SUSPENSION** of her mental health counselor license to resolve this matter. This indefinite suspension is considered discipline.

14. Respondent agrees not to use any words or titles which imply or represent that she is a licensed mental health counselor in the State of Iowa, or to otherwise hold herself out to the public as a licensed mental health counselor in the State of Iowa, or to engage in the practice of mental health counseling for which a license is required in the State of Iowa, while her license is suspended.

15. Respondent may request reinstatement of her license at any time. Any request for reinstatement shall be governed by 645 IAC 11.31 and 31.17. Respondent's license shall not be reinstated except upon a showing by Respondent that the basis for the suspension of her license no longer exists, and that it is in the public interest for the license to be reinstated. Respondent understands that if an initial request for reinstatement is denied, the Board may establish requirements that must be met prior to considering a subsequent request. If Respondent's license is reinstated, Respondent understands it may be placed on probation, or otherwise restricted, and that the length of probation and the conditions of probation, or the terms of any restriction, will be established through further order of the Board in conjunction with an order granting reinstatement of Respondent's license.

16. Should Respondent violate the terms of this Order, the Board may initiate action to impose other licensee discipline as authorized by Iowa Code chapters 147, 154D, and 272C and 645 IAC 13 and 33.

March 29, 2022
Date


HEATHER SAYER
Respondent

This Combined Statement of Charges, Settlement Agreement, and Final Order is approved by the Iowa Board of Behavioral Science on June 9, 2022.

/s/ Tony Alden
Tony Alden, Board Executive
Iowa Board of Behavioral Science